



EUROPEAN HEAT COUNCIL

WHAT EHC IS · AND WHAT YOU GET FROM IT

**Independent hot sauce maker? The courier  
earns more from your bottle than you do.  
EHC gets you a big company's shipping,  
and keeps your name on the bottle.**

**TODAY'S REALITY WHEN YOU SELL YOUR SAUCE ALONE**

**Making your sauce is the easy part.**

Selling it can be soul-destroying.

You are the warehouse, the packing bench, the export desk, the sales team and the advertising agency. On an average €8.84 bottle, domestic walk-in postage takes 41–47% of what your customer pays. Before your bottle crosses a border, the courier can earn nearly as much as you do. Across borders, even inside the EU, the economics collapse: shipping can cost more than your sauce.

**At that point your customer is not rejecting your sauce. They are abandoning the basket.**

When you stop, the business stops. Take a holiday and you close the shop. Pitch a wholesaler or a retailer and you are one more small supplier with another invoice, another delivery and another problem for that buyer to solve. It is easier for retail to ignore you than to stock you.

Online, you are up against mass brands and Amazon for attention. The contest is unequal before your first ad runs. Your nights disappear into filming Instagram Reels and hoping that is enough to be noticed.

EHSa builds trust in you. ChiliFest.eu puts your bottles in front of people who buy on the spot. Republic of Heat keeps them buying the rest of the year. ChiliFest.eu and Republic of Heat are both growing. Following EHSa media coverage, one maker increased sales from a typical 50 bottles per month to 400 in five days and secured a retail contract.

**The demand for your sauce is there. The infrastructure to serve it is not.**

**What you still lack is shared power.**

That is the job of EHC: put one serious market force behind you, and hundreds of makers like you.

[ IMAGE PLACEHOLDER · HERO ]

Your kitchen stays yours. Only the warehouse, the shipping and the buyers are shared.

WHERE THIS GOES · 10 YEARS

# Make Craft Hot Sauce a recognised retail category, stocked in as many European supermarkets as craft beer.

EHC is building the trade body, shared infrastructure and market identity you need to get there, and to keep more of the value you create.

## ALREADY RUNNING

- **EHSA** builds trust in you through independent judging, and gives the category the authority your name currently has to earn on its own.
- **ChiliFest.eu** puts you in front of people at events where they taste your sauce, meet you and buy from you on the day.
- **Republic of Heat** turns that into year-round sales through one curated shop where your customers can keep buying from you.

Those three already work. Everything else is built on top of them.

### 30 DAYS

#### Enter EHSA 2027

The revamp goes public with visitBerlin, and you can enter.

### 90 DAYS

#### You can be one of the first 80

The Maker Mark goes live. If you qualify, it goes on your label.

### 6 MONTHS

#### Your stock moves in

Your stock is among the first into one shared European centre. It opens once enough founding makers have signed to cover its running costs.

### 2 YEARS

#### Make it pay for you

You ship through shared fulfilment and wholesale and win repeat buyers. A shared kitchen is added only if cash flow supports it, for makers who want contract production.

### 10 YEARS

#### Put your bottle on shelves

Craft Hot Sauce as widely stocked in European supermarkets as craft beer, with your bottle on the shelf.

*In Ardore Concordia · strength in shared fire*

## In 30 days you can enter EHSA 2027. In 90 days you can join and carry the Maker Mark.

EHSA gives you the momentum. The Maker Mark and the first 80 members turn it into an organised European category, and you can be one of them.

### 30 days • EHSA 2027

- The EHSA 2027 revamp launches with visitBerlin.
- Entries open to you, wherever in Europe you are.
- You get the format, categories, timetable and judging model in writing.
- Judge, partner and media recruitment begins.

#### 30-DAY COMPLETION GATE

EHSA 2027 is public and you can enter from anywhere in Europe.

### 90 days • Membership + Maker Mark

- You join the first 80 EHC members across Europe.
- You get the definition of an independent Craft Hot Sauce maker in writing, so you know whether you qualify.
- The Maker Mark launches, with criteria you can measure yourself against.
- Its governance, verification and permitted claims are published, so you can check yourself against them first.

#### 90-DAY COMPLETION GATE

You are one of 80. The Maker Mark is live and you can put it on your label.

## THE PROBLEM, MEASURED

### Every order you take pays the courier before it pays you

On your own you pay the highest published rates. The farther your bottle travels alone, the more of its value goes to the courier.

#### THE ANCHOR CASE • FERMENT ISLAND, GOZO

**A customer buying one of Europe's best sauces spends €20 on shipping. And €9 on the sauce.**

**69% of the order goes to the courier.**

The same imbalance hits you closer to home. On an €8.84 average bottle in the Republic of Heat catalogue, German walk-in postage of €6.19–7.69 consumes 41–47% of a one-bottle order.

THE 42-PRODUCER CHECKOUT TEST

Only 9 of 42 makers showed a delivery price upfront.

**€4.90–15.50 delivery**

The lowest visible prices were all domestic German rates.

**The real price arrived late**

Many customers had to build a basket before learning what delivery would cost.

**Some purchases were impossible**

Shops were closed or broken, Germany was excluded, or minimum orders ruled out one bottle.



One maker, one parcel at a time. This is the job that eats your evenings and 41–47% of the order.

THE FIVE-FAVOURITES BASKET: FIVE REAL MAKERS, ONE BOTTLE EACH, TO BERLIN

| MAKER         | FROM    | BOTTLE | POSTAGE TO BERLIN |
|---------------|---------|--------|-------------------|
| Eckart Saucen | Berlin  | €7.50  | €5.50             |
| CZILLI        | Austria | €6.00  | €10.00            |
| Big Ginger    | UK      | €9.30  | €14.00            |
| Little Red's  | Ireland | €9.00  | €15.00            |
| MUNNVOLD      | Norway  | €13.00 | €15.50            |
| Total         |         | €44.80 | €60.00            |

Non-euro prices are converted and rounded for comparison.

The couriers currently earn a third more than all five makers combined.

Today: five separate parcels



Via one shared hub: one parcel



Same basket. Same five makers. Five parcels become one, and postage falls from €60 to €3.99. That is postage only. Storage and the per-parcel fee are separate.

sauce   postage

Shared infrastructure turns an order nobody places into one your customer will.

**Republic of Heat already ships this way:** a three-bottle set ships for about what most independent makers charge to send one. **ChiliFest.eu already proves the demand:** three days at capacity, with the entry queue at one point extending approximately 700 metres. EHC’s job is to put your bottles in front of those people all year, not for three days.

THE MARKET & WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

The market is growing. Independent makers are not.

THE CATEGORY PLAY

Cheaper postage is the part you feel first. A category with a name, a definition and a champion behind you is the part that lasts.

Craft beer reached 24.7% of US beer dollars after building all three over four decades. That is a precedent, not a timetable. Your kind of sauce has not had that moment yet.

What belongs

If you make hot sauce, chilli crisp, chilli oil or sambal, you are in it. Craft Hot Sauce covers the chilli-led products made by independent producers. It does not expand into the vague territory of “craft condiments.”

What makes it usable

The Maker Mark will define who qualifies, so you know where you stand. Independent heat testing will give your buyer a consistent measure of your heat. Together they give your buyer a way to tell what you are and how hot it is.

Four research houses agree: the market you sell into is growing.

€590–805m

Estimated European market today

€1–1.1bn

Forecast for the early 2030s

€100–150m

Derived independent market by 2030:  
10–15% of €0.9bn

Converted at €0.90 to the dollar. No source publishes a direct European craft share; the independent-market figure is a stated derivation informed by premium-condiment and craft-beer precedents.

Better access gives you room to outgrow the market.

The published growth rates describe the whole category. EHC’s thesis is that you should be able to grow faster than that baseline once customers can find you, buy your bottle alongside four others and receive it at a delivery cost that does not kill the order. That is an objective, not a research-house forecast.

PUBLISHED ESTIMATES FOR THE EUROPEAN HOT SAUCE MARKET

| RESEARCH HOUSE            | BASE ESTIMATE    | FORECAST           | CAGR  |
|---------------------------|------------------|--------------------|-------|
| Fortune Business Insights | \$655.18m · 2024 | \$1,134.81m · 2032 | 7.18% |
| IMARC Group               | \$894.1m · 2025  | \$1,151.5m · 2034  | 2.76% |
| Expert Market Research    | \$878.42m · 2025 | \$1,251.12m · 2035 | 3.60% |
| Market Data Forecast      | \$884.16m · 2025 | \$1.12bn · 2034    | 2.75% |

Commercial research estimates, shown in US dollars as published. They are directional, not audited market statistics.

There is no shelf with your kind of sauce on it, not in any grocer we surveyed.

**Zero craft shelves**

No retailer surveyed presented "Craft Hot Sauce" as a category.

**Premium demand exists elsewhere**

Specialists including Heatsupply, Pepperworld and Mexican Tears already sell the premium model.

**Range is limited by inventory**

Every one of them has to buy your stock before it can sell it, which is why most of them never call you.

THE UNCLAIMED POSITION

**Nobody in Europe is doing this for you yet.**

EHC can take that position without buying the stock: you keep ownership of your sauce and pay for the space you use. Existing stock-owning retailers cannot copy that without changing their business.

Evidence is strongest for Germany, the Netherlands and Austria. Southern Europe is not yet covered, and category-growth evidence remains limited.

THE RESPONSE

**You cannot build scale on your own.  
EHC builds it once, and you use it.**

WHAT EHC IS

**Four things you cannot do at your size.  
EHC does them once, and you use them.**

EHC builds the things you cannot build efficiently on your own. You stay independent; the infrastructure works collectively.

[ IMAGE PLACEHOLDER · SHARED HUB ]

One hub, every member's stock. Five parcels become one and postage falls from €60 to €3.99.

#### PILLAR ONE · B2C GROWTH

##### Your first sale, then all the rest

ChiliFest.eu gets you the first sale. Republic of Heat brings that customer back. EHC gets your bottle to the rest of Europe at a price that works.

#### PILLAR THREE · TRUST & AWARENESS

##### European Hot Sauce Awards

EHSa gives your unfamiliar name the recognition a customer can trust and a buyer can defend.

#### PILLAR TWO · B2B/B2B2C GROWTH

##### Your sauce in one trade range

You stop being one more small supplier. The buyer sees one range, one order, one delivery, with your bottle in it.

#### PILLAR FOUR · COST & COMPETITIVENESS

##### Shared logistics

Pooled shipping, storage and buying get you rates you could never reach on your own volume.

Republic of Heat is EHC's first customer and consumer sales channel. It is a separate company, not EHC.

#### THE OPERATING ADVANTAGE

### A Europe-wide range, and you still own every bottle.

You keep ownership and pay only for the storage and services you use. Your fee pays for the building, never for someone else's stock.

#### THE GROWTH ENGINE

## Trust brings you customers. Shared scale makes them pay.

Each one sells more of your sauce on its own. Run together, they feed each other.

[ IMAGE PLACEHOLDER · CHILIFEST CROWD ]

ChiliFest.eu: three days at capacity, the queue roughly 700 metres. The customers are already there.

#### AWARDS → DEMAND

##### Trust creates attention

A medal gets you press. Press puts you in front of people who have never heard of you.

#### DEMAND → BUYERS

##### Sales open trade doors

Sales you can point to give a buyer a reason to stock you.

#### BUYERS → VOLUME

##### More orders lower costs

Your bottles moving through one hub cut your cost per parcel.

#### SCALE → TRUST

##### The collective gets louder

Cheaper parcels let you sell into countries you cannot reach today. Then it starts again.

**Awards build trust.**  
**Trust creates demand.**  
**Demand wins buyers.**  
**Volume lowers costs.**  
**Lower costs help you grow.**

#### WHAT YOU PAY, AND WHAT YOU GET

### You keep your stock. You pay for what you use.

Your sauce can sit under one European roof without anyone buying it off you. You own the bottles and pay only for the shelf space and the services you use.

#### MEMBERSHIP

##### **Buys you the collective**

You pay a recurring annual fee. It buys you shared buying power and routes to market.

#### STORAGE

##### **You pay per carton**

You pay only for the shelf space you use. Your stock sits in the hub and orders go out while you are asleep, at a wedding, or making the next batch.

#### FULFILMENT

##### **You pay when it moves**

You pay EHC per parcel, and carriage is passed through to you at the pooled contract rate.

#### THE RESULT

**Every maker who joins after you makes your share of the fixed costs smaller, and gives the buyer one more reason to take the whole range.**

You get the reach and economics of a larger company. EHC never buys your stock, so nobody discounts it, dumps it, or decides which of your sauces deserves the space.

The first hub opens only when enough founding makers have signed to cover the running costs.

#### THE OPERATING HORIZONS

### 30 days. 90 days. Six months. Two years.

Two things in the next 90 days involve you: you can enter EHSA 2027, and you can take one of the first 80 memberships. The warehouse comes after that.

#### **30d** You can enter EHSA 2027

The EHSA 2027 revamp launches with the visitBerlin collaboration, the new competition is published, and you can enter from anywhere in Europe.

#### **90d** Organise the category

You join the first 80 EHC members across Europe, and the Craft Hot Sauce Maker Mark launches with published criteria and governance.

6m Your stock moves in

The first shared fulfilment centre opens, your stock goes in, and your sauce appears in the first collective catalogue for consumer and trade sales.

2y Prove it pays you

EHSA and the Maker Mark are established, you ship through pooled fulfilment and wholesale, and you win repeat buyers. Shared production is added only if cash flow supports it, and only for makers who want it.

THE TWO-YEAR TEST

Your delivered cost per bottle is lower than you can reach alone, you sell into more countries, and you sell more.

SUMMARY

You, and hundreds of makers like you, arriving at a buyer’s desk as one supplier.

The demand already exists. EHC gives you the shipping, the shelf and the recognition of a much larger company, and you keep your brand, your stock and your customers.

[ IMAGE PLACEHOLDER · ON THE SHELF ]

Where this ends: Craft Hot Sauce with a shelf of its own, and your bottle on it.

|                 |                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ALREADY RUNNING | EHSA builds trust in you, ChiliFest.eu gets you found, and Republic of Heat keeps your customers buying all year. |
| 30 DAYS         | The EHSA 2027 revamp launches with visitBerlin, and you can enter from anywhere in Europe.                        |
| 90 DAYS         | You join the first 80 EHC members across Europe, and the Craft Hot Sauce Maker Mark launches.                     |
| 6 MONTHS ONWARD | Shared fulfilment opens, collective consumer and trade sales are built, and you grow faster than you would alone. |

Every figure on these pages comes from the EHC strategy and is unchanged: the 42-producer checkout test, the 25-retailer category audit and the published market estimates. What is left out is the internal detail: the full surveys and the accounts. Ask and you can see them.

Questions, or want one of the first 80 places? [ contact address to confirm ]

*In Ardore Concordia*